*Asclepias tuberosa

Butterfly weed, Butterfly milkweed, Pleurisy root, Orange milkweed

Family: Apocynaceae (Asclepiadaceae)

Beltline N_S: 12 **TOTAL 12**



HABIT



OTHER



OTHER



FLOWER

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Not stated

Evergreen or deciduous
Herbaceous perennial

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: 1–3 ft (30–90 cm) tall × 1–2 ft (30–60 cm) wide. Clump-forming upright perennial.
Deep tuberous taproot

Sun

Water

Soil
Well-drained. Tolerates sand, loam, clay, poor, rocky, acidic to neutral. Prefers dry to medium, lean soils.
Deep taproot — does not transplant well once established

Zone 8a
Hardy Zones 3–9 (or 3B–10B). Excellent for Atlanta Zone 8a.
Drought- and heat-tolerant once established.
Prefers full sun and good drainage. Native to the region

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Native to eastern and southern North America.
Dry open woods, prairies, fields, roadsides, glades

Form
Herbaceous perennial. Clump-forming, upright, multi-stemmed from tuber. Not aggressive spreader. Emerges late in spring.
Important monarch butterfly host.
Does not have milky sap of other milkweeds

Foliage
Alternate or whorled, lanceolate to oblong, glossy green leaves. Clear (not milky) sap. Deciduous

Flowers and fruit
Bright orange (sometimes yellow or red) flat-topped clusters of star-shaped flowers. Summer (June–September). Attracts butterflies, bees, hummingbirds. Monarch larval host; Grayish-green pods with short hairs. Seeds with silky hairs

Bark
Green, pubescent stems. Not woody

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Plant in permanent full-sun location (deep taproot). Low maintenance. Self-seeds if pods left. Deadhead for possible rebloom. Cut back late winter/early spring. Excellent for butterfly gardens, dry borders, naturalizing.
2017 Perennial Plant of the Year

HEALTH

Health

Mostly pest-free. Aphids possible (spray with water). Crown rot in wet soils. Possible rust or leaf spot. Mildly toxic (cardiac glycosides); clear sap. Deer-resistant. Monarch host plant

Symptoms

None stated